Claim Review - Formal Factual and Legal Submission

Formal complaint: subject access handling, outstanding information and Claim Review coordination

From: Toms Jansons
Date: 9 October 2026
To: DWP Complaints Team; DWP Right of Access/Data Protection team and Data Protection Officer
For coordination with: Universal Credit Claim Review team and responsible manager

Revised submission - 9 October 2026. The factual cutoff remains 9 October 2026. Pale yellow passages identify additions or revised legal wording, including the final review of the escalation proposals. Section 9 contains the supporting legal statement. The supplied signed original remains separately preserved.

1. Complaint and requested outcome

Please investigate the handling of my **subject access request (SAR) of 17 July**, my **data-protection complaint of 31 August**, and my **service-complaint request of 17 September**. Please also resolve the outstanding Claim Review questions and confirm my **current claim and payment position**.

Please provide a coordinated written response identifying the records, decisions, responsible teams, next actions and correction routes. Preserve the original dates and correspondence.

Legal addition. I ask for practical safeguards: accurate records, lawful and proportionate use of my personal data, meaningful consideration of my explanations, and a written outcome with a usable correction or challenge route. Please protect my dignity by giving clear requirements and identifying who can resolve each outstanding point. These requests recognise DWP's responsibility to verify entitlement and do not seek exemption from relevant evidence requirements. See section 9.

84 calendar days have elapsed since the SAR. I have not identified a SAR acknowledgement or reference, substantive response, identification or clarification request, or extension notice. Please investigate receipt and routing. For any item DWP says it issued, provide a copy and the receipt, issue and delivery details.

I acknowledge DWP's substantive September explanations and Mohammed's **limited acknowledgement of 6 October at 14:52**. This complaint concerns the remaining questions, ownership, complaint registration and current position.

This is not a request to close my claim. It supplements the 7 and 21 September responses and 6 October journal message. It does not replace bank statements or suspend evidence or decision-challenge deadlines. No extension is assumed.

As at 9 October, I have received no further DWP acknowledgement, substantive reply, decision notice or payment statement after Mohammed's reply of 6 October at 14:52.

Separate matters for response

Matter	Original date	Responsible route and requested handling
A. Subject access request	**17 July 2026**	Right of Access team: complete the original SAR without resetting its date or scope.
B. Data-protection complaint	**31 August 2026**	Data Protection team/DPO: investigate the handling of the SAR and provide the complaint outcome.
C. Service complaint	**17 September 2026**	DWP Complaints team: confirm registration, ownership, document linkage and corrective action.
D. Claim Review and payment	**Review opened 25 August 2026**	Claim Review team and authorised decision-makers: confirm evidence, time, decisions and the current payment position.

2. Relevant recorded chronology

Dates: all chronology dates are in 2026.

Times: the recorded times follow the journal; the 6 October 14:52 reply is the separately supplied acknowledgement.

J: Universal Credit journal export.

R7: formal factual response dated 7 September.

R21: formal factual response dated 21 September.

A6: Mohammed's acknowledgement dated 6 October at 14:52.

Document references and access: see section 7.

2.1 Original access request and opening of the review

Date and source	Recorded event	Position to preserve
17 July, 12:26 - J	SAR made through my UC journal for personal data held by DWP, including UC/JCP records and listed categories where held.	**Original request date and scope;** no assertion that every category exists.
30 July, 12:57 - J	I requested routing to the Right of Access/data-protection team.	Follow-up to the existing SAR.
25 August, 15:42 - J	Claim Review opened; evidence requested by 8 September, with warnings about possible payment consequences.	Requirement and warning; no implemented consequence established by that entry.
31 August, 10:33 - J	I complained about the SAR's overdue status and asked for receipt, routing, response and any timing-adjustment details.	**Original data-protection complaint;** it did not replace the SAR.
31 August, 10:45 - J	I requested Claim Review clarification and additional time.	**An extension request, not an approved extension.**

2.2 September explanations, evidence date and complaint request

Date and source	Recorded event	Position to preserve
1 September, 14:13; 7 September, 11:23 - J	DWP explained the standard review, minimum four-month statement requirement, no redaction, approved UC route and opportunity to explain transactions.	**Substantive replies;** additional time or an alternative route was not confirmed.
7 September - R7/J	My formal response distinguished correspondence from the requested bank statements and requested post-deadline consideration.	It did not fulfil the statement requirement or pause the deadline.
8 September, 16:58; 9 September - J	DWP explained the review purpose, restricted access, UC document availability for up to 90 days and human decisions; reminders warned of payment effects.	Preserve these explanations and distinguish warnings from decisions.
10 September, 07:41 - J	I asked for the current route, deadline, extension outcome, consideration and decision status.	Requests for a factual current position and written communication.
15 September, 11:26 - J	Mohammed confirmed receipt of my 7 September message, said it would be considered and noted the extension request. He could not decide it and knew of no claim decision.	**Limited acknowledgement;** no confirmation of completed consideration or an extension.
15 September, 13:35 - J	Huzaifah created an upload link and requested four months of statements by 20 September.	**Later communicated submission date.**
17 September, 11:47 - J	I said I was arranging statement upload by 20 September and requested ownership, document linkage, answers on narrower evidence, incidental third-party data and retention elsewhere, and registration of a service complaint.	**Original service-complaint request available.** Registration and its reference need confirmation; the later 21 September response records my changed evidence position.

2.3 Later correspondence and outstanding current position

Date and source	Recorded event	Position to preserve
21 September, 09:38 - J	Mohammed said the evidence remained required, invited upload as soon as possible, warned of possible effects and signposted a separate complaint process.	This **preceded the 09:40 upload**; it cannot establish consideration of that later-uploaded PDF.
21 September, 09:40 - J/R21	The capital-evidence task was marked completed. My uploaded formal response recorded **statements prepared but not provided through the proposed route**, and **expressly disclaimed a closure request**.	**A correspondence upload,** not proof that bank statements were supplied or the requirement satisfied.
25 September, 14:19; 1 October, 10:43 - J	I requested claim/payment status, current evidence requirements, extension outcome, ownership and complaint information.	No pause, extension or particular decision was assumed.
6 October, 11:47 - J	I requested a six-point coordinated response and payment/required-action information by 8 October; I again said I was not requesting closure.	The requested date was not a statutory deadline or an agreed extension. I have not identified a reply answering those points.
6 October, 14:52 - A6	Mohammed, Sparkhill Jobcentre Plus, confirmed correspondence was noted and available for consideration in an ongoing review. He said the Claim Review team would advise on evidence, timescales, decisions, complaints and extensions.	**Limited acknowledgement and procedural signposting.** No confirmation of completed consideration, the payment position, an extension outcome or complaint registration.

3. Grounds requiring investigation

3.1 SAR and data-protection complaint handling

Please establish what happened to the 17 July request, the 30 July routing follow-up and the 31 August complaint. Internal routing, identification, clarification or delivery issues should be explained with their actual dates and records. A Claim Review reply does not, by itself, answer the separate SAR.

3.2 Outstanding information

DWP supplied meaningful explanations of purpose, statement scope, access, third-party relevance and human decision-making. The remaining issues include whether narrower evidence can meet the purpose, the outcome of alternative-route and additional-time requests, protection of incidental third-party information, and retention of copies, extracts or resulting records elsewhere. The UC viewing/removal explanation does not establish the lifecycle of every such record.

3.3 Ownership and continuity

Alia, Mohammed and Huzaifah are identified journal contributors. That does not establish which role can decide an evidence alternative, additional time, a payment referral or the complaint. Please investigate whether the relevant correspondence was linked and considered, and identify a coordinating contact with access to the responsible teams.

Mohammed's 6 October reply confirms that correspondence was noted and remained available for consideration. Its general procedural wording does not establish that the responsible reviewer considered the two PDFs or that any specific question was answered. The description of an ongoing review is not a decision notice or confirmation of the payment position. Please provide those case-specific confirmations rather than relying on the acknowledgement alone.

3.4 Accurate record and consequences

Please distinguish receipt from substantive consideration, correspondence uploads from bank statements, warnings from decisions, and decisions from implemented payment effects. If any adverse conclusion about my engagement is relied on, identify the conduct, evidence and correction or challenge route. Preserve my original words alongside any later correction. Criticism of service handling should be assessed separately from the evidence and entitlement questions.

3.5 Impact on wellbeing and essential costs

Repeatedly reconnecting messages, documents and unanswered requests has affected my wellbeing and concentration. Uncertainty about payment affects planning for essential living and housing costs. Please take this into account when prioritising a response and exercising any available discretion. I am not asserting that an unconfirmed payment loss or housing consequence has already occurred.

Relevant mitigating circumstances — added 9 October 2026. I am unemployed as at 9 October 2026. I was homeless from 26 August 2025 to 14 May 2026, after my planned departure from study in 2025. This period of instability explains why clear requirements, realistic timescales and written outcomes matter to me. Please consider it when exercising any available discretion on time, communication or evidence handling. I recognise that the relevant evidence still needs to be provided.

3.6 Personal circumstances and accurate status records

Residence record — added 9 October 2026. UKVI’s letter dated 22 October 2019 records a grant of settled status under Appendix EU. DWP’s UCD357 letter dated 7 January 2026 records that I have a right to reside and am habitually resident as “EEA - EU - Settled Status”. Please retain that decision accurately. If residence status is material to this review, confirm the current status recorded by DWP, the source and date of verification, and any changed facts or different issue relied on. That letter did not itself decide all conditions of my Universal Credit award. See section 7.3.

Former student and work history — added 9 October 2026. My full-time, in-person Diagnostic Radiography (Pre-registration) studies at the University of Suffolk ended for me in June/July 2025. The certificate produced on 23 January 2025 confirms full-time enrolment then and gives an expected completion date of 31 January 2027; it does not establish my status in October 2026. I worked at Iceland Foods, Harborne High Street, during 2021–2024. If student, employment or income records are material to this review, identify the period and information relied on so I can address any discrepancy with relevant evidence. See section 7.3.

Residence grounds. My recorded status is settled status, and DWP accepted my right to reside and habitual residence on 7 January 2026. While that status is held, current unemployment does not by itself remove the qualifying right to reside or require me to prove a separate retained-worker or self-employment right. Please retain the accepted finding and, if DWP proposes to revisit it, identify the lawful basis, facts and evidence relied on and give me a usable opportunity to respond through the applicable process. Section 9.7 explains the settled-status rule and section 45 of the Border Security, Asylum and Immigration Act 2025. Other Universal Credit conditions and relevant evidence requirements still apply.

4. Information and corrective action requested

Please address each request below and preserve the four separate matters identified in section 1. Evidence requirements, entitlement decisions and complaint outcomes require their own answers.

4.1 Current claim, review and payment position

Confirm whether the review remains open, the current claim and payment position, and any action now required. For any decision or action affecting my claim or payment, provide its notice, reasons, evidence relied on, legal or administrative basis, decision date, effective date, implementation/payment position and applicable challenge route and deadline. If none has been made, state the current stage and next step.

Payment record requested. Please identify the assessment period, amount, elements and actual payment date for any payment affected, including any housing-cost element. If payment has been suspended, state whether this is in whole or in part and what must be done for payment to resume. If entitlement has changed, provide the separate decision and any arrears, recovery or repayment calculation. I have not established that any such action occurred; these particulars are needed to understand and, where appropriate, challenge the actual position.

Legal addition. Please distinguish an evidence requirement, suspension of payment and a decision changing or terminating entitlement. Identify the particular power and notification relied on, and any discretion exercised, including relevant hardship considerations. A warning or an upload-task status is not confirmation that any of these actions occurred. The applicable conditions and challenge route depend on the action; see section 9.5.

Applicable benefit rules. If DWP relies on a legacy-benefit transition, social-security coordination or a cross-border rule, identify the particular benefit and award, relevant personal and territorial conditions, operative provision and date, any saving or exception, and the notice relied on. Please explain its effect on this claim. My nationality, past study or employment at Iceland Foods in England does not by itself establish which such rule applies. See section 9.5.

4.2 Original SAR and data-protection complaint trail

Confirm DWP's recorded receipt date, responsible team, reference, referrals and present status for the 17 July SAR. Identify any timing adjustment, the legal basis, relevant dates and notification. Provide a separate record for the 31 August data-protection complaint, identifying its registration, acknowledgement, handler, investigation and outcome. Do not restart or replace either original chronology.

4.3 Access to personal data

Complete the original SAR, supplying my personal data and the applicable supplementary information. Where held and within scope, include journal/internal messages, claimant and work-coach notes, attendance and decision records, referrals, disclosures, relevant flags/profiling, access/audit records relating to me and archived records. Identify relevant systems searched and explain any omitted category, exemption or redaction insofar as disclosure is legally permissible. I do not assume every category exists or that entire third-party records must be disclosed. If records created after the original request require a separate additional access request, record that separately and continue handling the original request without resetting it.

Legal addition. Please assess held information by its content, purpose or effect in relation to me, rather than limiting access to my name or isolated identifiers. Search relevant departmental holdings within the original scope where reasonable and proportionate, and include context where necessary to make my personal data intelligible. This is subject to Article 15(1A), applicable exemptions and others' rights; it is not a demand for every document or all underlying reasoning. Ashley v HMRC supports this bounded approach; see section 9.2.

4.4 Case-specific processing explanation

Identify the purposes, legal bases, specific recipients (or categories where legally permitted) and retention periods or criteria for the relevant records. DWP's charter describes general processing grounds; please explain their application here. Clarify the treatment of incidental third-party information and copies, extracts or records outside the UC viewing service. State the scope of the 8 September assurance about automation and whether automated matching, profiling or risk scoring was used in my case, identifying human involvement and any information required by the applicable access rights. I am requesting clarification, not alleging that such processing occurred unlawfully.

Legal addition. Please distinguish recipient disclosures from access by staff acting under DWP's authority, and identify the relevant role/team where a staff name cannot properly be supplied. Identify the processing ground rather than assuming consent is required. If a solely automated significant decision within the current Articles 22A–22C is identified, explain the safeguards for information, representations, human intervention and contesting it. Matching or profiling alone does not establish such a decision. See section 9.3.

4.5 Evidence requirements and requests for additional time

State the outstanding evidence, exact statement period, approved submission route and current deadline. Give the outcome and reasons for my requests for more time, narrower evidence or an alternative submission/review route. If another team must decide, identify it and confirm referral, ownership and a response date.

Legal addition. Where regulation 45 applies, please identify the information-requirement notification and explain the period allowed and consideration of any longer period shown to be necessary. Please also consider the impact described in section 3.5 when exercising available discretion. I do not claim an automatic entitlement to redaction, an alternative route or an extension, and do not present prepared-but-unprovided statements as compliance. See section 9.5.

4.6 Ownership and document linkage

Identify the review lead or team, coordinating contact, responsible manager and roles authorised to decide evidence, time and payment matters. Confirm access to, and substantive consideration of, my 7 and 21 September responses and relevant journal messages. List answered points, remaining points and the team responsible for each. Explain any inability to provide an individual's name and identify a usable role/team contact instead.

Legal addition. Please give my relevant explanation meaningful consideration through the applicable process and a usable opportunity to address any material adverse concern, so that participation can affect the assessment. Confirm what was considered and what remains to be answered. This is a request for fair, practical handling in its context; it does not assert a universal oral-hearing right or a duty to defer every action. See section 9.6.

4.7 Service complaint and record correction

Confirm registration, reference, handler and expected response for the 17 September service complaint. If it was not registered, register it now while retaining the date first raised and investigate the delay. Explain how I can challenge inaccurate personal data or case notes. Please preserve originals and correction history, relevant decision records and audit/referral records for the outstanding access and complaint work, subject to lawful retention requirements.

Please structure the response so that each item identifies its answer or outstanding status, supporting record, responsible team, next action and date. Referral alone should not be presented as resolution. If an error is established, identify the correction, affected records or decisions and any remedy considered.

Legal addition. Under Articles 5(1)(d) and 16, inaccurate personal data concerning me should be rectified without undue delay and incomplete data completed as appropriate to the processing purpose. In particular, please check any record relied on against the distinctions in section 3.4 and my express no-closure position. Identify the disputed record and correction route, retain a clear history where lawful, and distinguish recorded opinion from fact; disagreement alone does not make an opinion inaccurate. See section 9.4.

4.8 Correct status and benefit-decision routes

Legal representation. Please address the residence record and grounds in sections 3.6 and 9.7 if residence is material to this review. If any benefit decision relied on is identified and disputed, provide the decision, notification and available revision or challenge route, and refer the issue to the authorised decision-maker. A data correction or service complaint must not be treated as deciding the benefit award.

Conditional decision correction. If the records establish that a specified decision arose from a qualifying official error or another statutory ground for revision at any time, I will identify that decision, the particular factual or legal error and the evidence relevant to its original date. Please then consider the application under the correct provision and provide the written outcome and applicable reconsideration or appeal information. General dissatisfaction, hardship or delay alone does not establish official error. This submission does not identify a particular adverse benefit decision or itself supply a completed decision-specific reconsideration or appeal. Ordinary challenge deadlines must still be addressed promptly. See section 9.8.

5. Timeframes, communication and separate routes

5.1 Subject access and data-protection complaint timeframes

Revised legal basis. UK GDPR Article 12(3), read with Article 12A, requires action without undue delay and ordinarily within one calendar month from the applicable starting point. A necessary complexity/number-of-requests extension requires notice and reasons within the initial period. Identification, a lawful fee or reasonably required clarification may affect the calculation only where the applicable conditions are met. If DWP received the SAR on 17 July, without an applicable timing adjustment, the ordinary response date was 17 August, 53 calendar days before this submission. Please provide the actual calculation, notices and delivery evidence; internal routing alone does not establish a valid adjustment. [1] See section 9.1.

Revised legal basis. DPA 2018 section 164A(3)–(5) requires acknowledgement within the 30-day period beginning when the complaint is received, appropriate steps to respond without undue delay, progress information and notification of the outcome without undue delay. The relevant duties apply to complaints received on or after 19 June 2026. If DWP received my data-protection complaint on 31 August, 39 calendar days had elapsed by 9 October and the 30-day acknowledgement period had expired. Please provide the receipt and acknowledgement records, enquiries, updates and outcome, or explain what remains outstanding and when it will be completed. Keep this separate from the SAR and service-complaint clocks. [2] See section 9.1.

5.2 Complaint response and interim confirmation

Please acknowledge this submission, confirm routing and provide references and response dates within five working days of receipt; this is my requested interim timeframe. DWP publishes a usual 15-working-day complaint-resolution target but currently warns of delays due to high complaint volumes. Please give a realistic date and progress updates, and provide the live payment information without waiting for the complaint outcome. [3]

5.3 Written communication

Please use my journal wherever reasonably practicable, provide substantive outcomes in writing and confirm an alternative correspondence route if journal access changes. My earlier 48-72-hour processing-time request does not itself change a deadline.

5.4 Separate escalation and decision-challenge routes

If unresolved, I may raise the data-protection matters with the ICO, supplying the original request and complaint, correspondence, chronology and available evidence of impact. This does not assume a fixed ICO completion date or an award of compensation by the ICO. For service maladministration, I may use DWP's final-response route to the Independent Case Examiner and, after its final response, seek MP referral to the Parliamentary and Health Service Ombudsman, subject to the published time limits. I may also seek independent legal advice. This complaint does not replace any applicable mandatory reconsideration or appeal. [3][4]

Legal addition. DWP’s published procedure requires its final complaint response before ICE, with contact within six months of receipt; after ICE’s final response, MP referral to PHSO is subject to the published 12-month period. For a challengeable benefit decision, mandatory reconsideration is usually requested within one month of the decision; the actual notice, legal route and any extension conditions must be checked promptly. Waiting for this complaint or SAR does not extend that period. See section 9.5.

Older decisions. A qualifying application for revision at any time is a distinct route with its own conditions. It is not a general extension of the usual deadline and does not mean every old decision can be reopened. Please provide the actual decision records so the appropriate route can be assessed without waiting for the SAR or complaint outcome. See sections 4.8 and 9.8.

6. Declaration and signature

To the best of my knowledge, this accurately distinguishes the recorded correspondence, my current concerns and the confirmations I seek. Please retain it with the Claim Review record and route the access and complaint matters to their responsible teams without losing their separate dates.

Printed name	Signature
Toms Jansons	

Date: 9 October 2026

Signature record: the visible signature is reproduced from the supplied image; the original signed files remain unchanged. The accompanying verification bundle contains new integrity signatures and checks for this revised copy. These concern file integrity only and do not certify identity, factual or legal correctness, claimant approval of revised wording, or a trusted signing time.

7. Documents relied on and download links

The documents and journal records relied on are identified below. Please link them to the appropriate case records and confirm receipt and substantive consideration.

7.1 Downloadable documents

Access password for all four links: 00000000

Password format: eight digits, no spaces.

Download availability: 90 days.

Link continuity note. These are the original links and availability statement. Revising this copy does not replace the document at the F9 link or restart availability. The final production version is the separately supplied document. Remote contents and password access have not been checked in preparing this revision.

Ref.	Document	Download link
R7	Formal factual response dated **7 September 2026**, pages 1-2.	7 September response
R21	Formal factual response dated **21 September 2026**, pages 1-2.	21 September response
S1	Screenshot of the original **17 July 2026 SAR** journal entry.	SAR screenshot
F9	This formal submission dated **9 October 2026**.	9 October formal submission

7.2 Journal and acknowledgement records

Ref.	Record and location
J	Universal Credit journal export, supplied as Journal entries(3).md; relevant entries from 17 July through 6 October. Entries are identified by date and time in section 2.
A6	Mohammed's reply, Sparkhill Jobcentre Plus, **6 October 2026 at 14:52**. The separately supplied acknowledgement is recorded in section 2.3. It confirms correspondence was noted and available for consideration; it does not supply the outstanding case-specific answers.

7.3 Sources for the additional personal context

Added 9 October 2026. These sources support section 3.6. The original four links are unchanged. No new public download link is asserted, and this list does not establish that the Claim Review team has received or considered these sources.

Ref.	Source	What it establishes or leaves open
UKVI19	UKVI settled-status letter dated **22 October 2019**, PDF pp.2–4.	Records the historical grant; the letter expressly says it is not proof of status.
HRT7	DWP **UCD357**, dated **7 January 2026**, p.1.	Records acceptance of right to reside and habitual residence under EU settled status; not an award determination on every condition.
ST25	University of Suffolk student certification produced **23 January 2025**, p.1.	Confirms full-time enrolment then and expected completion on 31 January 2027; does not record withdrawal or current status.
PC9	My additional account supplied **9 October 2026**.	Current unemployment, study cessation in June/July 2025, work history and the stated homelessness period; further primary records can confirm details where material.

8. Official references

Guidance checked on 9 October 2026. These sources explain the relevant procedures; the case records establish what was communicated in this case.

1. ICO - Responding to a subject access request.
2. ICO - Handling data-protection complaints.
3. DWP - Complaints procedure, decision challenges and escalation.
4. ICO - Making a data-protection complaint.
5. DWP - Personal information charter. Relevant to subsection 4.4.
6. ICO - Right of access and supplementary information. Relevant to subsections 4.3 and 4.4.
7. DWP ADM chapter C1 - residence, C1871, and ADM 15/25 - section 45, paragraphs 1–9. See section 9.7.
8. TR and GD v SSWP [2025] UKUT 332 (AAC) - corrected judgment, paragraphs 116–121, and DWP ADM 13/25 - revision at any time, paragraphs 3 and 6–8. See section 9.8.
9. Data (Use and Access) Act 2025, sections 78, 80(1), 103 and 142(2)(b), and SI 2026/82, regulations 2(h), 2(j), 3(a), 4, 5 and 7. See sections 9.1–9.3.
10. DWP ADM 12/25, paragraphs 3–14, read with ADM 7/26, paragraphs 3–7. Transition dates depend on the award and cohort; see section 9.5.

9. Legal basis supporting the requested action

Incorporated annex — research and revision dated 9 October 2026. This annex supports sections 1, 3–5. It adds no historical event, finding of breach, benefit decision or proved payment loss. The supplied signature and its provenance note appear in section 6. The separately attachable annex contains the same text.

9.1 Access and data-protection complaint are separate duties

Original SAR — sections 4.2–4.3 and 5.1. UK GDPR Articles 12(3) and 12A govern the response period. The timing amendments in DUAA 2025 section 76 commenced on 5 February 2026; the saving for earlier requests does not apply to a July request. An adjustment requires its own lawful conditions and dated evidence. Please identify actual receipt, any necessary identification or clarification request, extension notice and reasons, and the response/delivery record. On the conditional 17 July receipt → 17 August ordinary calculation, the interval to 9 October is 53 calendar days. Actual receipt and any lawful adjustment still require investigation. See commencement regulations 2(h) and 4 and reference [1].

31 August complaint — sections 4.2 and 5.1. DPA 2018 section 164A, inserted by DUAA section 103, requires facilitated complaints, acknowledgement within the 30-day period beginning when the complaint is received, appropriate enquiries and progress information, and an outcome without undue delay: subsections (2)–(5). On receipt on 31 August, 39 calendar days had elapsed by 9 October, beyond the acknowledgement period; actual receipt and steps taken remain to be established. Regulations 3(a) and 7 of the commencement instrument apply the acknowledgement/response duties to complaints received on or after 19 June 2026. Please identify the original receipt and actual compliance steps. The 30-day acknowledgement period is not a fixed period for completing every investigation, and does not postpone the duty to respond without undue delay. No separate statutory SAR acknowledgement deadline is asserted. [2]

9.2 Personal data, relevant searches and intelligible copies

Sections 4.3 and 4.6. Michael Ashley v Commissioners for HMRC [2025] EWHC 134 (KB), paragraphs 139–146, 161, 175–184, 189–194 and 204–210, supports examining information about an individual by its content, purpose or effect, considering relevant departmental holdings, and supplying context where necessary for intelligibility. The tax-investigation facts differ from this review. The judgment rejects treating an entire enquiry, every policy document or all decision-making reasoning as personal data. Its application to held DWP records requires the relevant information and controller relationship, not an assumption about what exists.

The current search limit is UK GDPR Article 15(1A), inserted by DUAA section 78: reasonable and proportionate searches. Section 78 came into force on Royal Assent, 19 June 2025, under section 142(2)(b); it did not require inclusion in SI 2026/82. Please identify the relevant holdings searched and explain limitations insofar as legally permissible. Access remains to personal data and required supplementary information, with necessary context; it is not unrestricted document disclosure. Article 15(4) and DPA 2018 Schedule 2, including applicable crime/risk-assessment, third-party and privilege provisions, may limit disclosure where their specific conditions are satisfied. A general “review” label does not itself establish an exemption. [6]

9.3 Lawful processing, privacy and automation

Section 4.4. UK GDPR Article 15(1)(a)–(d), (g)–(h) concerns purposes, categories, recipients, retention, sources and applicable automation information. Articles 13(1)(c) and 14(1)(c) separately address purposes and legal basis when their conditions apply. Article 6 and DWP's charter permit grounds other than consent, including legal obligations and public functions. Please identify the actual ground and purpose here and how relevant, proportionate evidence and incidental third-party data are handled. External recipients and internal staff acting under the controller's authority are different questions; usable role/team contact is requested without asserting a right to all staff names. [5][6]

DUAA section 80(1) expressly introduced Articles 22A–22D. It commenced on 5 February 2026 under regulation 2(j) of SI 2026/82; regulation 5 preserves specified safeguards for pre-commencement decisions. Under Article 22A, a significant decision has a legal or similarly significant effect and is solely automated where there is no meaningful human involvement. Article 22C requires information, representations, human intervention and a contest route for decisions within its scope. Please explain any applicable safeguards if such a decision is identified. Automated assistance, matching or profiling alone does not establish that threshold; DWP's 8 September assurance about human decisions remains part of the record. Special-category conditions are separate and no unlawful automation is alleged. See DUAA section 80 and commencement regulations 2(j) and 5.

9.4 Accuracy and usable correction

Sections 3.4 and 4.7. Articles 5(1)(d) and 16 support correction without undue delay of inaccurate personal data and completion of incomplete personal data, taking account of the processing purpose. Please check the particular record relied on against the correspondence: availability is not completed consideration, a correspondence upload is not statement provision, a warning is not an implemented decision, and I expressly declined closure. A record of an opinion is not inaccurate merely because I disagree with it; its character, source and factual basis should be clear. Identify the disputed record, correction made or reason for refusal, and the applicable complaint route. Preserving a clear original/correction history is requested subject to lawful retention, not as an unlimited retention duty. See ICO rectification guidance.

9.5 Evidence requirements, payment action and challenge

Sections 4.1 and 4.5. The Universal Credit etc. (Claims and Payments) Regulations 2013, regulation 38(2)–(3), provide for relevant information requirements. The Universal Credit etc. (Decisions and Appeals) Regulations 2013 distinguish suspension grounds (regulation 44), information requirements/non-compliance (45), termination after suspension (47), and notification where a decision carries an appeal right (51). Where regulation 45 applies, the notified information period is 14 days or a longer period allowed or shown necessary under regulation 45(4). This is distinct from the one-month-or-longer period and full-suspension conditions in regulation 47. The actual notice and route are essential; these provisions do not automatically create a fresh deadline on receipt of a complaint.

Current DWP decision-maker guidance, chapter A4, A4600–A4601 and A4621–A4632, addresses hardship and individual circumstances when relevant discretion is exercised. Please identify the current requirement, notice, period allowed, extension outcome and any action actually taken. DWP can lawfully require relevant evidence; my statements remain prepared but unprovided. Privacy requests do not create an automatic right to redact, withhold or substitute evidence. The guidance cannot itself establish that a decision or payment change occurred here.

Conditional transition or coordination issue — section 4.1. ADM 12/25 and ADM 7/26 describe different legacy-benefit cohorts and exceptions. The December 2025 ESA rule and the July 2026 changes cannot be substituted for one another indiscriminately. The July rules contain run-on, appointee and other award-specific conditions; they do not establish a general July 2027 abolition of Housing Benefit. I have not established that I hold an award affected by these provisions. If relied on, please identify the actual award, operative law, cohort, date, exception and notice. Any separate cross-border question likewise requires the relevant benefit and personal, territorial and temporal facts, rather than a conclusion from nationality alone. [10]

Section 5.4. The Social Security Act 1998 sections 8–12 and the applicable regulations govern decisions, revision/supersession and appeals, with exclusions and prerequisites. A suspension and an appealable entitlement decision are not interchangeable. Please supply the actual notice and correct route. GOV.UK mandatory reconsideration guidance gives the usual one-month period; this complaint does not extend it. An appeal to the Upper Tribunal normally follows a First-tier Tribunal decision and requires permission on an error of law; this submission does not initiate that appeal. Service escalation follows DWP’s final response → ICE (six months) → ICE final response → MP/PHSO (published 12-month period), subject to the applicable requirements. [3]

9.6 Participation, dignity and practical answerability

Sections 1, 3.3–3.5 and 4.1, 4.5–4.7. R (Osborn) v Parole Board [2013] UKSC 61, paragraphs 67–71, explains the importance of relevant information, participation and respect for persons affected by decisions. It concerned parole and oral hearings; no automatic hearing right is claimed for this UC review. R (Reilly and another) v Secretary of State for Work and Pensions [2013] UKSC 68, paragraphs 64–65, supports access to information needed for meaningful representations where benefit-related requirements may affect living needs. Its JSA work-scheme facts and historical legislation do not invalidate this bank-statement requirement.

Fairness remains sensitive to the actual statutory scheme: Secretary of State for the Home Department v Kolicaj [2025] UKSC 49, paragraph 77, illustrates a different regime in which the appeal structure satisfied fairness without prior representations. Accordingly, I request clear case-specific requirements, consideration of relevant explanations, written outcomes and a usable lawful challenge route, rather than assuming a universal procedural entitlement. An itemised coordinated response and a role/team contact are proportionate administrative requests; no general duty to name every employee or reopen every decision is asserted.

9.7 Settled status, dated records and individual consideration

Sections 3.6, 4.8 and 7.3 - residence. The UKVI letter records a 2019 settled-status grant; HRT7 records DWP's acceptance on 7 January 2026. ADM C1, C1871 states that EU settled status, as indefinite leave to remain, satisfies the right-to-reside limb for UC without separately establishing an EEA worker or self-employed right. Pre-settled status is a different route. Please apply the recorded status to its proper scope, subject to verification that it remains held. Current unemployment alone does not undo that residence right. The January letter does not decide every award condition.

Section 45. Border Security, Asylum and Immigration Act 2025, sections 45 and 65(3)(c), read with ADM 15/25, paragraphs 1–9, addresses citizens' entry/residence rights where EUSS qualifying residence was not residence under the relevant treaty rules. It commenced on 2 December 2025. The memo directs DWP to rely on Home Office EUSS status while held, without a separate Withdrawal Agreement Article 10 scope assessment. It expressly preserves the ordinary habitual-residence and benefit-specific eligibility rules. I rely on this bounded clarification, not a blanket guarantee of benefit or an exemption from evidence requirements.

Sections 3.5–3.6 and 7.3 - other circumstances. Please consider my unemployment and reported homelessness period where material to current requirements or available discretion. The January 2025 certificate establishes enrolment then; its expected completion date confirms neither current student status nor the actual cessation date. My June/July 2025 cessation remains my account, subject to relevant evidence. DWP's student guidance explains that student status and income may affect UC. The historic UKVI letter is not current digital proof, consistent with GOV.UK status guidance. Relevant dates and primary evidence remain necessary. No completed Suffolk qualification, student-finance treatment or finding on all benefit conditions is asserted.

9.8 Revision at any time and a usable decision-challenge route

Sections 4.8 and 5.4 - statutory grounds. Under the applicable decision scheme, SI 2013/381, regulations 2 and 9(a) provide for revision at any time of a decision arising from official error. The definition requires a qualifying official source and excludes material contribution by the claimant or someone outside the listed official bodies, and an error of law shown by a subsequent Upper Tribunal or court decision. A service failure or inaccurate note does not, without more, establish that the award decision arose from such an error. Other statutory revision grounds depend on their own conditions.

TR and GD. In TR and GD v SSWP (PIP/ESA) [2025] UKUT 332 (AAC), paragraphs 118–121, an application after 13 months must raise, in substance, grounds which, if made out, could amount to official error or another relevant any-time ground; it need not meet an arguable-case threshold. DWP consideration is required before tribunal jurisdiction arises. Appeal time ordinarily runs for one month from the revision notice being sent, with a maximum 13-month extension subject to the rules. A valid appeal permits merits consideration of the original decision; a supersession appeal remains bounded by the statutory supersession scheme. The judgment supplies a route, not a finding that my case satisfies it.

Application and limits. ADM 13/25, paragraphs 3 and 6–8, requires the decision and particular factual or legal grounds to be identified, without technical wording or a prescribed form. DWP should give the appropriate written outcome; appeal rights are not endlessly repeatable. I seek the records needed to identify any actual disputed decision and its correct route. Prepared but unprovided statements remain an unresolved evidence issue, not proof of official error. Sections 4.8 and 5.4 preserve the ordinary challenge route and deadlines. No unlimited reopening, automatic revision, arrears or compensation is asserted.